Shaniah Reece

Ph.D. Student, Department of Computer Science, Emory University
streece@emory.edu | linkedin.com/in/shaniah-reece | reecey22.github.io

EDUCATION

Emory University *May 2023 – Present*
Ph.D. in Computer Science

Emory University *Expected December 2026*
M.S. in Computer Science

University of Maryland, Baltimore County *Aug 2019 – May 2023*
B.S. in Information Systems

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-computer interaction, participatory and speculative design, physical computing and health equity, with a focus on co-designing technology with Black women in computing and with women navigating menopause.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

CARE Lab, Emory University, Atlanta, GA *Aug 2024 – Present*
Graduate Research Assistant

- Designed and facilitated speculative co-design workshops with 3 menopausal women and 4 clinicians to generate interventions for menopause care and education, centering participants from marginalized communities
- Design and facilitate co-design workshops with 4 OB/GYN residents and 4 attending physicians to evaluate the menopause curriculum, surfacing gaps and prioritizing opportunities for improvement
- Analyze survey and interview data from participants to inform subsequent workshop design, bringing patient perspectives to clinicians and residents
- Built a research partnership with an online menopause community of 15,000+ members to understand health needs, interaction dynamics and opportunities for collaboration
- Review design methods and frameworks used in menopause research to identify gaps in current approaches

DETOUR Lab, Emory University, Atlanta, GA *May 2023 – Present*
Graduate Research Assistant

- Co-created a pop-up makerspace expanding access to making and technology for Black women, serving 10 participants across 7 sessions
- Co-facilitated co-design workshops teaching Black women in computing to combine craft practice with technology, spanning novice to intermediate skill levels
- Trained 6 researchers in design thinking and guided them from initial concept through a tested final prototype
- Conduct qualitative analysis of transcript data using the Sort & Sift, Think & Shift method
- Lead literature reviews, present findings in lab discussions and mentor undergraduate research assistants on study design, data collection and analysis

National Center for Atmospheric Research (NCAR), Boulder, CO *May 2022 – Jul 2022*
SIParCS Intern

- Applied NCAR's Data Assimilation Research Testbed (DART) to an extended SEIR epidemiological model to improve COVID-19 forecasts
- Demonstrated the benefit of ensemble data assimilation on COVID-19 data from four countries, including sparse data and missing parameters
- Tuned the model with ensemble methods, including the Kalman filter and rank histogram filter, and contributed the code to the project's Git repository
- Presented findings at NCAR, the University at Buffalo conference and the UMBC McNair Conference

UMBC Data Science Corps, Baltimore, MD *Oct 2021 – May 2022*
Data Science Fellow

- Collaborated with five undergraduate students under Dr. Arrya Gangopadhyay and Ph.D. candidate Anamika Paul on data processing for a project to identify illicit online drug sales
- Processed hundreds of millions of Twitter records with querying strategies in Microsoft Excel, researching legal dispensaries to avoid mislabeling data
- Completed training on smart-city technologies and built robotics projects in Scratch and Python

PUBLICATIONS

★ Best Paper Award

Peer-Reviewed Conference Papers

1. **Shaniah Reece**, Nyah Rene, Khloe Wright, Andrina McQuick, and Yolanda A. Rankin. 2027. "Stitching Resistance: Turning a Makerspace into a Counterspace for Black Women." In *Proceedings of the 58th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education V. 1 (SIGCSE TS 2027)*, February 17–20, 2027, Sacramento, CA, USA. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 7 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3857222.3860124. To appear.
2. ★ Yolanda A. Rankin, **Shaniah Reece**, Covenant Adenuga, Jakita O. Thomas, Jamika Burge, and Aisha J. Roberts. 2026. "Creating Counterspaces for Black Women in Computing." In *Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Research on Equitable and Sustained Participation in Engineering, Computing, and Technology (RESPECT 2026)*. ACM, New York, NY, USA. https://doi.org/10.1145/3796496.3811775. **Best Paper Award.**

Other Articles

3. **Shaniah Reece**, Covenant Adenuga, Tierra Ablorh, and Yolanda Rankin. 2025. "A Powerful Sisterhood: Black Women Scholars in Feminist HCI." *ACM Interactions*, January–February 2025.

Workshop & Doctoral Consortium Papers

4. **Shaniah Reece**, Maya Kobayashi, Manvi S., Maria Elena Cunningham, McKenzie Reese, Miriam Asare-Baiden, Selen Bozkurt, Azra Ismail, and Nadi Kaonga. 2026. "Co-designing Care Infrastructure for Menopause." *Women's Health as Cooperative Work: Participatory AI Across Care, Community, and Policy Workshop at CSCW 2026*.
5. **Shaniah Reece**. 2025. "Designing the AfroVerse for Black Women in Computing." Doctoral Consortium. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Research on Equitable and Sustained Participation in Engineering, Computing, and Technology (RESPECT 2025)*. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 383–384. https://doi.org/10.1145/3704637.3734748.

AWARDS & HONORS

★ Best Paper Award, RESPECT 2026, for "Creating Counterspaces for Black Women in Computing"	*2026*
ACM-W Scholarship	*May 2026*
Women in Natural Sciences Fellowship	*May 2023*
Resident Assistant of the Year, UMBC	*May 2022*
Grace Hopper Celebration Scholar	*May 2022*
CWIT Inclusive Excellence Award, UMBC	*May 2021*
Tapia Conference Scholar	*May 2021*
Center for Women in Technology (CWIT) Scholar, merit-based, UMBC	*May 2019*
Lockheed Martin Scholarship	*Aug 2019*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Foundations in HCI, Emory University, Atlanta, GA	*Jan 2025 – May 2025*
Research Methods in HCI, Emory University, Atlanta, GA	*Aug 2024 – Dec 2024*
Computing, AI, Ethics, and Society, Emory University, Atlanta, GA	*Aug 2023 – Dec 2023*
Volunteer Summer Tutor, Building Steps Non-Profit, Baltimore, MD	*Jul 2021 – Aug 2021*

INVITED TALKS & PANELS

"Preparing for Graduate School and Research," Sister Circles, Emory University	*2026*
Prestigious Scholarships, Research Opportunities and Graduate School Prep Panel, CWIT, UMBC	*2025*
"Let's Talk Grad School," McNair Program, UMBC	*2024*
"Understanding the Graduate Experience," Sister Circles, Emory University	*2024*
CWIT Welcome Reception, UMBC	*2023*
College of Engineering and Information Technology Student Panel, CWIT, UMBC	*2023*

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

RESPECT Conference and Doctoral Consortium	*Jul 2025*
ACM SIGCSE Technical Symposium	*Feb 2025*
BlackComputeHer Conference	*Feb 2025*
UMBC McNair Conference	*Sep 2022*
Grace Hopper Celebration	*Sep 2022*
University at Buffalo Undergraduate Student Conference	*Jul 2022*
SIParCS Symposium, NCAR	*Jul 2022*
Tapia Conference	*Sep 2021*

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

JPE Ambassador, Emory University	*Aug 2024, Aug 2025, Aug 2026*
Computer Science Ambassador, Emory University	*Aug 2024 – Jun 2025*
Secretary, Laney Graduate Student Council, Emory University	*May 2024 – Jun 2025*
International Student Liaison, Emory University	*May 2024 – Aug 2024*
Lead Resident Assistant, Residential Life, UMBC	*May 2022 – May 2023*

President, CWIT Student Council, UMBC	*May 2022 – May 2023*
Resident Assistant, Residential Life, UMBC	*Aug 2021 – May 2022*
President, International Students Connect, UMBC	*Aug 2021 – May 2022*
Historian, CWIT Student Council, UMBC	*Aug 2020 – Jun 2021*
Best of CWIT Committee Member, UMBC	*Aug 2019 – Oct 2020*
First Year Ambassador, Student Government, UMBC	*Oct 2019 – Aug 2020*

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Association for Computing Machinery (ACM)	*2023 – Present*
ACM SIGCHI Atlanta Chapter	*2024 – Present*

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

CITI Information Privacy and Security	*Aug 2023*
HIPAA@Emory	*Aug 2023*
CITI Health Privacy and Behavioral Security	*Jul 2023*
CITI Human Subjects Protection	*Jul 2023*
Digital Technology Credential: Generalist, Greater Washington Partnership	*Sep 2022*
CITI Social and Behavioral Responsible Conduct of Research	*Nov 2021*

SELECTED COURSE PROJECTS

Tactile Map with Multimodal Input for Low-Vision Users	*May 2024*
Decision Support System for the Miami International Airport	*Dec 2022*
Restaurant Management Database System	*Dec 2022*
Maryland YMCA Daycare Database Design	*May 2022*

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Division of Information Technology, UMBC, Baltimore, MD *Jun 2021 – Oct 2021*

Desktop Student Technician

- Installed software to security standards, re-imaged machines, set up accounts and supported users in person and remotely